ANIESH DAS

🛍️ SHOPSMART – *SOLVING DISCOVERY FATIGUE IN NICHE E-COMMERCE*

1. PRODUCT VISION & MISSION

Vision:

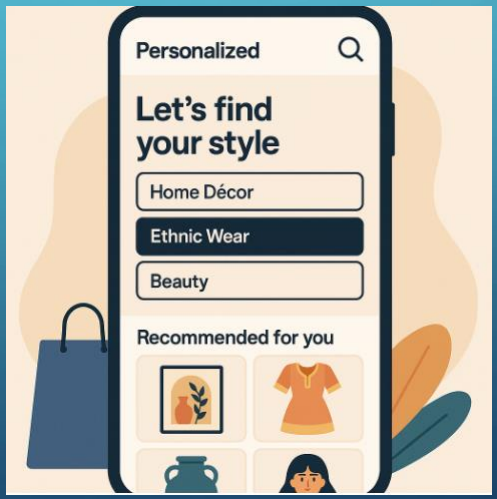
Create an e-commerce experience where every shopper instantly sees items that feel hand-picked for their unique taste, eliminating endless scrolling and turning discovery into delight.

Mission:

Today, ShopSmart learns each user's evolving style signals and guides them through a personalised, streamlined product journey—from inspiration to confident purchase—in less than five minutes.

2. PROBLEM STATEMENT

When I browse niche products online (like ethnic wear or home-décor), I want to find items that match my style and intent quickly, but I struggle because filters are rigid, search results feel endless, and recommendations miss the mark—leading to fatigue and checkout abandonment.



3. JOBS-TO-BE-DONE (JTBD)

JTBD Statement

1. When I'm furnishing my first apartment, I want earthy, handmade décor ideas surfaced instantly so I don't waste evenings scrolling generic listings.

2. When I shop for ethnic wear for an upcoming festival, I want outfits pre-filtered to my size, colour palette, and cultural relevance so I can choose confidently without comparing hundreds of options.

4. USER RESEARCH PLAN

Participants

- 5 frequent niche-category shoppers (home-décor, ethnic wear, beauty)
- 3 occasional “gift” buyers
- 2 sellers of niche products (to understand catalogue constraints)

Methods & Timeline

Contextual inquiry (observe a live shopping session) – 45 min each

Think-aloud usability test on a competitor flow – 30 min each

Diary study capturing decision points & drop-offs over one week

4. USER RESEARCH PLAN

Key Research Questions

- How do users currently narrow down large catalogues?
- Where does decision fatigue arise in the journey?
- Which cues (visual, social proof, metadata) drive perceived relevance?
- What's the moment they abandon or persevere?

Success Metrics to Validate

Time to first relevant item (<2 min target)

Drop-off rate before adding to cart (-20% target)

Self-reported mental load (NASA-TLX) improvement (-25% target)

5. PERSONA CREATION

Riya, 24 – Interior design enthusiast browsing for home accents

- **Goals:** Curate a stylish living space that reflects her personality
- **Frustrations:** Overwhelmed by irrelevant results, unsure if items will match room
- **Shopping context:** Mobile, budget-conscious, inspired by social trends

Anil, 32 – Festival shopper looking for ethnic gifts

- **Goals:** Find culturally relevant and stylish gifts quickly
- **Frustrations:** Rigid filters, unclear product uniqueness, tight deadlines
- **Shopping context:** Desktop, moderate budget, event-driven urgency

6. CUSTOMER JOURNEY MAP (CJM)

Persona: Riya

Stage	Actions	Thoughts	Emotions	Pain Points
Inspiration	Browses Pinterest, clicks ads	“I want my space to feel cozy & earthy”	Curious, hopeful	Gets lost outside the platform
Search	Enters "boho planter" in search bar	“Too many items, where do I begin?”	Overwhelmed	Generic results, not tailored
Filter	Applies price, category filters	“Still too broad, nothing catching my eye”	Frustrated	Filters don’t reflect style
Evaluation	Opens several tabs to compare	“This might work—but will it match?”	Unsure, tired	Repetitive, visual clutter
Drop-off	Closes site without saving	“I’ll come back later…”	Fatigued	No smart shortlist or save cues

7. FLOW DESIGN

- **User Flow:**

Home Page → Style Snapshot Quiz → Personalized Shortlists → Product Detail Page → Add to Wishlist → Checkout Nudge Bundles

8. WIREFRAMES (LOW-FIDELITY)

Design includes 5 key screens:

1. **Style Snapshot Quiz Page** – Choose preferred aesthetics, colors, themes
2. **Results Summary** – Highlights 3 curated themes like "Boho Earth", "Muted Minimalist"
3. **Product List with Adaptive Filters** – Dynamically sorted by style, popularity
4. **Smart Shortlist View** – Stack of grouped, related products
5. **Checkout Suggestions** – Bundles shown based on items added to wishlist/cart

9. USER STORIES + ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

User Story 1: As a buyer, I want to see curated collections based on my style, so that I don't have to scroll endlessly.

- **Acceptance Criteria:**
  - Given I've completed the style quiz
  - When I land on the results page
  - Then I should see 3+ visually coherent, curated shortlists

User Story 2: As a gift shopper, I want to filter by occasion + cultural relevance, so I find meaningful options faster.

- **Acceptance Criteria:**
  - Given I selected "Festive Gift" filter
  - When I view results
  - Then only culturally tagged options should show, in preferred price range

10. EFFORT ESTIMATION USING STORY POINTS

Feature	Story Points	Rationale
Style Snapshot Quiz	8	Medium complexity, UI/UX needed, some ML logic
Adaptive Filters	13	High logic + interaction depth, needs robust testing
Smart Shortlists	5	Easier to implement via tagging & clustering initially

11. PRIORITIZATION FRAMEWORK: RICE

➡ **Prioritise** Style Snapshot quiz first for high return with lower risk.

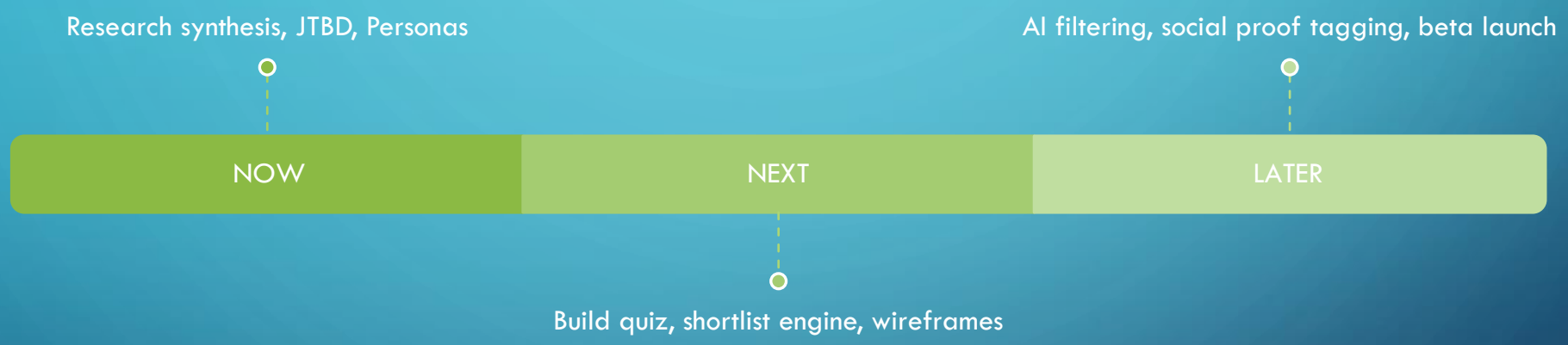
Feature	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE Score
Adaptive Filters	800	8	90%	13	443.08
Style Snapshot	600	9	85%	8	573.75
Smart Shortlists	500	6	95%	5	570

12. MINIMUM VIABLE PRODUCT (MVP)

MVP Feature: Visual Style Snapshot Quiz → Curated Product Clusters

- Validates if personalization reduces discovery time
- Testable via A/B version against traditional search

13. ROADMAP (NOW–NEXT–LATER)



14. USABILITY TESTING PLAN

Tasks to Perform:

- Complete style quiz → navigate shortlists → add product to wishlist → view checkout bundle

Success Criteria:

- Time to shortlist < 2 mins
- Satisfaction survey > 8/10
- Drop-off rate < 15%

Metrics to Collect:

- Click depth, quiz completion time, wishlist adds, bounce rate, Net Promoter Score

15. (BONUS) AI THINKING

AI/ML Enhancements:

- **Personalized product ranking** via user-item embeddings
- **Auto-tagging** of images using visual classifiers
- **Theme-based dynamic grouping** based on style patterns
- **Drop-off prediction** using session behavior signals (e.g. hesitation + back-clicks)